

use long sentences. Sometimes what you have to say cannot be said any shorter, but use them sparingly. The objective is to keep the reader's mind engaged. Too many short sentences can also be disorienting. Group your thoughts into paragraphs. Keep a logical flow from one thought to the next.

Till you get comfortable and confident with your writing, be prepared to proof read what you've written. If you are using Microsoft Word you can also use their Spelling and Grammar (Press [F7] or **Tools > Spelling and Grammar**) tool to check for spelling and grammatical errors. Remember that the tool is just a guide and you will have to make your own judgment and decide what is right. For example, a general rule of writing is to avoid passive sentences. MS Word may highlight certain sentences as passive. Your decision to change it to the active voice should be dependant on the context and not just what MS Word says! Also, turn on readability statistics (**Tools > Options > Spelling and Grammar > Show Readability Statistics**). This will further help you get a general idea about how readable your post is. There are three readability metrics that are helpful:

- **Passive Sentences:** Shows the percentage of passive sentences in the entire document. Lower is better. Aim for anything less than 5-10%
- **Flesch Reading Ease:** A measure of how easily readable your document is. On a scale of 0 to 100, higher is better.
- **Flesch-Kincaid Grade Level:** A measure of how easily readable your document is to grade school (primarily US/English speaking) kids. Lower is better. Aim for a typical score of between 10-12.

Again, remember that these tools are just a guide. The final decision is yours.

2.2.3 Be Topical... Or Not!

This is one of the great debates in blogging. Should blogs be personal diaries? Should they be opinions on things of 'popular importance'? Should they be a description of how bad your lunch was?